

Aging and People with Disabilities

Number: APD-PT-26-006

Authorized by: Corissa Neufeldt

Issue date: 4/28/2026

Subject: APS Screening Decisions and Documentation

Transmitting (check the box that best applies)

- ☒ New policy ☐ Policy change ☐ Policy clarification ☐ Executive letter
☐ Administrative Rule ☐ Manual update ☐ Other:

Applies to (check all that apply):

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ All ODHS employees | ☐ County DD Program Managers |
| ☒ Aging and People with Disabilities | ☐ Developmental Disabilities Services |
| ☒ Area Agencies on Aging: -- Type B -- | ☐ Self-Sufficiency Programs |
| ☐ Child Welfare Division | ☐ Support Service Brokerage Directors |
| ☐ Children's Intensive In Home Services | ☐ Stabilization and Crisis Unit |
| ☐ Children's Residential Services | ☐ Other (please specify): Enter Text |

Policy/rule title: APS Screening Decisions and Documentation

Policy/rule numbers: OAR Chapter 411, Division 020, Adult Protective Services

Release number:

Effective date: May 01, 2026

Expiration date:

References: QRG – APS Screening Decisions and Documentation and APD-APS-040-001

Timeframes and Deviations

Web address:

Discussion/interpretation

This policy transmittal cancels APD-PT-24-028 - APS Screening Decisions: Documentation and Notification to Reporters and collects information from prior policies and Quick Reference Guides (QRGs) about APS screening into a new policy.

The policy transmittal is effective **May 01, 2026**:

1. BASIC ELEMENTS OF AN APS SCREENING DECISION:

Screening decisions documented by APS in the Centralized Abuse Management system must contain enough detail so that an external reviewer can understand why the screening decision was made and what available information and screening-related rules and policies were used to reach the screening decision. Basic elements that must be documented include:

- a. Information regarding the alleged victim's (AV) age and any reported disability, if known. These details will be the basis for eligibility decisions.

For example: A report of abuse of a 40-year-old adult with no reported physical disability would not be assigned for APS investigation due to eligibility factors. "AV is not eligible for APS due to age and lack of reported physical disability."

- b. Details about the location of the reported incident, and the identity and role of the alleged perpetrator at the time of the incident, if known. These details will be the basis for jurisdictional decisions.

For example: A report of abuse of an elderly adult residing in a prison by a correctional official would not be assigned for APS investigation due to jurisdictional reasons. "AV is not in APS jurisdiction due to location of incident and identity/role of the AP."

- c. The nature of the reported incident or conduct, and the risk of harm or actual harm faced by the AV as a result. These details will be the basis for deciding whether the incident, if it occurred as reported, would (or would not) meet the APS definition of abuse or self-neglect.

For example: A report an APS-eligible adult experiencing an incident which did not present any actual harm, or risk of serious harm, to the AV, would not be assigned for APS investigation. In such cases, you do not need to cite an abuse OAR, just state the circumstance and the name of the abuse type.

For example: The reported incident did not meet the APS definition of Neglect due to no reported harm or risk of serious harm to the AV.

Additional information about the screener's thought process is helpful.

For example: "The reported incident did not meet the APS definition of Neglect due to no reported harm or risk of serious harm as AV was accompanied by staff when they left the secured unit and were able to be redirected back into the unit."

- d. If a report is assigned for investigation, screeners must name the APS abuse type that the report potentially meets. Specific OAR numbers or subsections are not necessary.

For example: "Report assigned for investigation for Neglect due to AV leaving secured unit unsupervised."

Screeners must reference any supplemental information available to the screener from other sources (collateral contacts, databases such as CAM and Oregon Access, etc.) that support the decision.

For example: "Age of AV was unknown by reporter, but screener review of Oregon Access (OA) confirms that AV is over 65 and receiving Medicaid LTSS. Case manager notified."

2. SCREENING DECISION TIMELINE:

- a. Pursuant to policy, APD-APS-040-001 Timeframes and Deviations, the following applies:
 - i. Screening, as defined in OAR 411-020-0060, begins upon receipt of a report of suspected abuse or self-neglect by the local office. A report of abuse is considered to have been "received," and screening begun, on the date and at the time of its receipt, if received during Business Hours. After Business Hours, the report is considered to have been received at the beginning of the next Business Day (8:00 AM to 5:00 PM Monday through Friday, excluding holidays as determined by the state).
 - ii. A screening decision as used in this document means whether eligibility, jurisdiction, and definitional criteria are met and the report will be assigned for investigation, or they are not and the report will be

closed at intake. That screening decision is required to be made no later than the end of the next Business Day following the day of receipt of the report.

3. WHERE TO DOCUMENT SCREENING DECISIONS IN CAM

- a. For all intakes with allegations, the rationale and supporting elements for the screening decision must be documented in the “Reason for Screening Decision Detail” field in CAM.
 - i. Based on the elements described in (1) an example of a screening decision is as follows: “AV is eligible for APS services due to a reported disability. AP1 is alleged to have been rough while providing AV care, injuring AV by causing marks and bruising. Assigned for physical abuse.”
 - ii. In the next example the screener provided information they found in Oregon Access. Although this information wasn’t necessary to assign the intake for investigation, it was information the screener found and considered when making their decision: “AV is eligible for APS investigation due to being over the age of 65. Assigned for investigation for neglect of care due to AP failing to provide toileting assistance to AV resulting in skin breakdown. AP is AV’s paid caregiver and AV is a full assist in toileting per Oregon Access.”
- b. For all non-abuse intakes, the rationale for the screening decision to close at intake must be documented under the “Additional Notes” field in CAM.
 - i. Based on the elements described in (1) an example of a screening decision is as follows: “AV is eligible for APS services due to age and reported disability. AV is being released from the hospital and will need some assistance with ADLs. No abuse reported, referrals made for LTC services.”
- c. Examples and instructions are available in QRG - APS Screening Decisions and Documentation.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE REVIEWS:

- a. Central APS will conduct periodic quality assurance reviews of CAM intakes and share the results with local APS offices.
- b. Screening quality assurance reviews will look at areas, including timeliness of screening decisions, and thoroughness of documentation of screening decisions.
- c. Performance targets for reviews will be set, and corrective actions by local APS offices will be required when they do not meet performance targets.

Implementation/transition instructions

This policy transmittal represents one of the process changes related to the Temporary OAR update effective May 01, 2026. Additional information will be sent out regarding this OAR update.

Training/communication plan

The policy transmittal will be posted at the [APS Staff Tools](#) website, [APD's Transmittals](#) website, and the CAM Knowledge tab with other APS policy transmittals. Communication and discussion regarding this policy transmittal will occur during APS supervisor meetings, APS Training, and other venues as needed. Requests for technical assistance on applying this policy transmittal should be sent to the Central APS Unit at APS.TechAssistance@odhsoha.oregon.gov.

Local/branch action required

Please discuss these changes with staff during huddles and staff meetings. Ensure local APS workers awareness of the policy transmittal and where it is posted on the [APD Transmittals Public Facing](#) website.

Central office action required

Respond to inquiries regarding this policy transmittal as needed.

Reviewed by impacted parties? ☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, reviewed by: APD Operations Committee, APS Supervisors, APS Policy Advisory Committee, Central APS Unit, Safety Oversight & Quality

Filing instructions:

If you have any questions about this action request, contact:

Contact(s): Central APS Technical Assistance

Email: APS.TechAssistance@odhsoha.oregon.gov